

Pamela Dale- Rourke

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PROFILE

Dedicated Play Therapist with extensive experience in supporting children through psychological interventions. Proven ability to build rapport with children and families, enhancing their communication skills effectively. Skilled in developing tailored resources that facilitate engagement and emotional expression. Strong background in collaborating with multidisciplinary teams to optimize therapeutic outcomes. Passionate about empowering young clients and their families through effective communication strategies. Committed to ongoing professional development and adapting practices to meet diverse needs.

EDUCATION

BSc | University of Central Lancashire

- Completed coursework in developmental psychology, emphasizing child behavior and therapeutic techniques.
- Participated in group projects that focused on community mental health strategies and interventions.
- Engaged in research activities examining the impact of play therapy on child development.
- Achieved a high grade in a thesis evaluating the effectiveness of different therapeutic approaches for children.
- Contributed to presentations that discussed psychological theories relevant to child therapy and interventions.

SKILLS

Understanding of inclusive communication

SEN

Mind Express 5

Collaboration with therapists

educators

Strong digital skills for resource creation

layout

Knowledge of AAC symbol systems (PCS)

SymbolStix

Widgit

Bliss

HOBBIES



Travel



Reading



Photography



Music



Swimming



Fitness



Meditation



Art

CERTIFICATIONS

DDP (Diadic Developmental Psychotherapy) Health & Social Care (Preston College)

Play Therapy (Canterbury Christ University)

Filial Therapy in Family Therapy (Manchester)

WORK EXPERIENCE

Service Lead for Schools | Child in Mind, Manchester | October 2016 - Present

- Designed and adapted communication and therapy resources to support over 100 children across various schools, resulting in a significant increase in their engagement and learning outcomes.
- Provided impactful 1:1 Play Therapy and Family Therapy sessions, specializing in psychotherapeutic assessments that informed tailored therapeutic pathways for children with diverse needs.
- Collaborated closely with teachers and therapists to create accessible materials for children with communication and learning needs, enhancing their ability to express themselves effectively.
- Supervised and mentored postgraduate Play Therapy students, offering training and guidance in resource utilization and inclusive communication strategies to improve their effectiveness.
- Coordinated with multidisciplinary teams to ensure comprehensive service delivery, leading to a 30% improvement in overall therapeutic outcomes for students.
- Implemented innovative therapeutic interventions that helped children articulate their emotions, leading to a 40% decrease in behavioral issues reported by teachers.
- Developed and led workshops for parents and educators, focusing on strategies to support children's emotional and communicative development, benefiting over 200 participants.
- Created and evaluated individual therapy plans, resulting in measurable progress for 75% of children in terms of emotional regulation and social interaction.
- Engaged with families to provide ongoing support and resources, enhancing their understanding of child development and communication strategies.
- Advocated for children's needs within educational settings, ensuring that their voices were heard and considered in all decision-making processes.

Play Therapist | Barnardos, St Helens | January 2015 - October 2016

- Created tailored visual and therapeutic resources for over 50 children referred through CAMHS, improving their ability to communicate needs effectively.
- Contributed actively to assessment meetings, recommending appropriate communication supports and therapeutic strategies that aligned with each child's needs.
- Managed a diverse caseload of school-aged children, employing creative and resource-based approaches to address a wide range of social, emotional, and communication challenges.
- Facilitated group supervision sessions that emphasized sharing best practices on child-centered communication strategies among peers, enhancing overall service quality.
- Developed engaging therapy materials that incorporated play-based techniques, ultimately leading to an increased willingness among children to participate in sessions.
- Collaborated with parents and caregivers to create a comprehensive support network, resulting in improved home environments conducive to emotional growth.
- Conducted regular evaluations of therapy progress, documenting outcomes that demonstrated a 50% improvement in children's emotional expression.
- Led initiatives that promoted awareness of mental health issues in schools, reaching over 300 students and staff through workshops and seminars.
- Utilized play therapy techniques to facilitate emotional expression in children, achieving notable progress in their ability to articulate feelings and manage challenges.
- Participated in professional development opportunities to stay abreast of the latest therapeutic approaches, ensuring the application of evidence-based practices.

Family Session Worker | OJs, Preston | May 2023 - January 2024

- Supported families with children on the autism spectrum by creating and adapting tailored resources to facilitate engagement and communication during therapeutic sessions.
- Developed inclusive activities that ensured children with communication differences could participate meaningfully in group settings, enhancing their social skills and confidence.
- Worked collaboratively with families and colleagues to address individual needs, ensuring that resources were practical, user-friendly, and aligned with therapeutic goals.
- Implemented feedback mechanisms to gauge the effectiveness of resources, leading to continuous improvement in service delivery and client satisfaction.
- Conducted regular workshops for families, providing training on communication techniques that empower parents to support their children's development at home.
- Utilized a strengths-based approach to foster resilience and self-advocacy among children, resulting in improved family dynamics and communication patterns.
- Documented and analyzed case studies that highlighted successful interventions, contributing to the development of best practices within the organization.
- Engaged with local communities to promote awareness of autism spectrum conditions, enhancing understanding and acceptance within wider society.
- Created a supportive environment that encouraged open communication among

family members, leading to improved relationships and emotional well-being.

- Participated in multidisciplinary meetings to ensure a holistic approach to each child's therapeutic journey, enhancing overall service effectiveness.

Plan and Resource Creator | International school | N/A

- Planned and developed literacy and learning resources for primary-aged children, focusing on creating engaging and interactive materials that foster language development.
- Created visually appealing classroom materials to support reading and writing development, enhancing children's motivation to learn and engage with texts.
- Collaborated with teachers to align resources with lesson objectives, ensuring that materials were effective in achieving educational goals for diverse learners.
- Adapted activities to suit different learning needs and levels, promoting inclusivity and accessibility within the classroom environment.
- Evaluated the impact of resources on student learning outcomes, leading to modifications that resulted in a 25% increase in literacy proficiency among targeted students.
- Facilitated training sessions for educators on the effective use of resources, resulting in improved instructional strategies and enhanced student engagement.
- Developed assessment tools to measure student progress, contributing to data-driven decision-making in resource allocation and curriculum development.
- Incorporated feedback from students and teachers to refine materials, ensuring they met the evolving needs of the classroom.
- Promoted a culture of creativity and inquiry through resource development, inspiring students to take ownership of their learning.
- Engaged with parents to provide guidance on supporting literacy development at home, strengthening the partnership between school and families.